Unami Lodge, One LEC January Meeting Minutes
28, January, 2025
Cradle of Liberty Council #525
Reading the Vote final numbers: Yay/Nay/Abstain/No vote

Opening

Attendance: Natalie Sidlow, Todge Sutkowski, Zach Gilinger, Leah Callahan, Nicole Nichols-Quinn, Bob Deck, Matt Rouleau , Dr. David H. Sirken , Sophia Carroll, Larry Arinsberg, Skye Kramer, Liam Lynch, Cullen Dougherty, Nathan Schooler, Sophia Carroll, Mike Gilinger, Marina Darcas, Laura Guy, Natalie Sidlow, Griffen OBrien, Glenn Campbell, Douglas LeBlanc, Michael Evans, Robert Raggi, Jr., Ian Brumm, Aidan Porter, Andrew Smallberger, Phil Hittner, Gregg Slocum, Brian Darcas, David Gibbons, Jerry Reed, Martin Stacey, Star McMackin, Luke Smallberger

Motion: Luke Smallberger - I would like to make a motion to approve last month's meeting minutes. Seconded by: Leah Callahan PASSED

Committee Reports:

- AIA (Cullen Dougherty)
  - No Report Submitted
- Brotherhood (Griffen O'Brien)
  - The Brotherhood Committee has been fast at work for the Month of January! We already met and are talking about ways we can change the committee this year for the better. We also discussed ways we can seal more bonds or gain a retention rate higher than last year. Our committee also prepped our bins and reached out to printing already to get the forms reprinted that we need for the year. Next step is to secure a location for the Blitz!
- Camp Promotions (Amelia LeVay)
  - No Report Submitted
- Ceremonies (Noah Goldberg)
  - No Report Submitted
- Communications (Nathan Schooler)
  - The Communications Committee is doing good. We've rolled out a ton of new things! Lots of posts on our storyboard, so keep an eye on our social media pages! We've also implemented a request form in the Slack communications channel for Committees, Chapters, and advisers to submit requests. Not sure what the Communications Committee can do for you? Check out the service offerings document that was recently shared in the general channel!
- Conclave (Skye Kramer)
  - Our 2025 fundraiser items are available for purchase at weekends and on the online trading post: patch set ($20) and dri-fit long sleeve ($30)! If you are interested in attending this year's conclave, we highly recommend you signing up and joining our waitlist. Also for all of you who are attending there will be a virtual

information session coming in late April, early May so keep your eyes peeled for that!

- Events (Leah Calahan)
    - No Report Submitted
- History (Aidan Sutkowski / Marty Reph)
    - No Report Submitted
- Inductions (Jaclyn Keyser)
    - No Report Submitted
- Klondike (-)
    - No Report Submitted
- LLD (Matt Rouleau)
    - The LLD committee has BIG things cooking right now. Keep an eye out for various announcements and emails sharing opportunities as well as information that can be applicable to you.
- Lodge Operations (Sophia Carroll)
    - This past year the Lodge Operations Committee had a number of successes. We conducted the lodge officer elections at this past Fall Fellowship which went by very smoothly, and beforehand we supervised and added to the lodge officer nomination list. On top of that great accomplishment we had our annual Awards and Recognitions meeting, which ended in a select few people being chosen by the selection committee to receive an award for their amazing contributions.

    - I'm looking forward to another great year and many more amazing achievements for Lodge Ops this year as we prepare for the possible Rules and Procedures changes that come ahead as well as the 2025 Lodge Officer Elections and the 2025 Awards and Recognitions process and selection.

- Membership (David Zangwill)
    - There are currently 501 paid members of the lodge. Regarding the LEC members, 50 out of the 92 LEC members have paid their dues. Please pay your dues to the lodge for 2025.
- NOAC (Will Beardsley)
    - No Report Submitted
- Officers (Martin Stacey)
    - No Report Submitted
- Ordeal (Andrew Smallberger)
    - No Report Submitted
- Service (Ian Brumm)
    - No Report Submitted
- Unit Elections (Marina Darcas / Douglas LeBlanc)
    - February 22nd Unit Elections training from 9:00 am - 1:00 pm. Please come to this training to become a better member of your chapters unit election team. The training will be at the council office.

- Unit Representative (Douglas LeBlanc / Marina Darcas)
    - No Report Submitted
- Vigil Honor (Zach Kline)
    - No Report Submitted

Chapter Reports:

- Baden Powell (Dalton Samuel) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Conestoga (-) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Constellation (Christopher Stasen) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Continental (Mathew Yankowski) [Y:A:]
    - No report submitted
- General Nash (Brayden Leibel) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Lafayette (Douglas LeBlanc) [Y:A:]
    - Lafayette Chapter recently ran the annual Klondike Derby. All units were in attendance at the Klondike. The chapter is also now working on a Chapter patch design to present at a later LEC.
- Minquas (Gabe Oberholzer) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Northern (Cullen Dougherty) [Y:A:]
    - Northern Chapter is currently working on its first ever Chapter patch!
- Roosevelt (-) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Triune (Amelia Levay) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Washington (Aidan Porter) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted

Reports

2025 Lodge Dinner Report Actual (Leah Callahan)

Here is the 2025 Lodge Dinner Budget Actual. There were 243 participants and the income from the dinner added up to $10,490. We bought 300 patches at a cost at $2.90 due to rush shipping which in total was $870.00. For program we purchased Record Stickers for $67.84 and we bought from Amazon for $134.72, totalling up to $202.56. We ended up paying $30 for the Chicken, $32 for the Beef, and $30 for the Vegetable meal. All of this came out to be a total of $7,604 and we tipped the Alloy $1,824.96. We also had 2 special guests, Matt Carlson and Laila Labib, to cover them we paid $85. There was no money spent on Audio or visuals. Our

total income came out to $10,490 and our total expenses came out to be $10,586.52. Overall we lost $96.52.

Business

Unami Lodge, One Proposed Budget (Star McMackin)

The opening balance for the Lodge account is $31,510.44

The income for 2025 is estimated to be somewhere around $22,895.31. This comes from Dues, Late Fees, and net Processing Fees being $16,654.77 because of the timing of the prices andis based off of 992 people paying dues. Profit from Properties we estimate will be $5,000 because the Trading post is supplementing the $1,000 deficit that it's in. The Section E17 Rebate will be $740.54, this is from the leftover money that the section returns to us. We plan to receive $500 in donations during the year.

The lodge expenses are budgeted to be $22,895.31.

The lodge charter fees will be $5,952 due to the fact that we will be paying $6.00 per member of the lodge (1,083 members).

Printing and Publications covers anything related to the Ordeal Packets, brotherhood Certificates, and anything else we need to print throughout the year. This will cost us about $1,000 after everything is considered.

We are giving a $1,000 donation to the council which is the same amount given last year. We intend to also give donations in forms other than monetary donations.

Training will receive $5,505. We will be sending members to the Section Leadership Conference for $35.00 per person, and we will be sending 15 attendees for a total of $525.00 which is covered by the lodge. This year we are not sending representatives to NLS. This year we are adding a Polestar training event that will be hosted by Unami with a couple other lodges planned to attend (Ajapeu, Woapalanne, and Octoraro) on May 31st, the Polestar training adds $2,900 to the Training budget. LLD will also be extended this year and will include a dinner, so the required funding will be increased.

The postage fee is going to $1,000 due to the fact that the fees were posted late last year so we had to put them onto the 2025 budget. This is for 2 budgets worth of postage and will not be this high in 2026.

Officers Expenses will be $1,000 which covers name tags, the trailer registration, having a national officer at one of the lodge weekends, the OA holiday party, and the Leadership Dinner. We already have the officer patches so we do not need to purchase those.

We are allotting $1,850 towards recognitions because we are budgeting for the 2025 recognitions and the 2024 recognitions. This is higher because we had an outgoing Lodge Advisor, 3 Founder awards, and a Distinguished Service award. Some of the other awards we already had possession of and did not need to be purchased.

Vigil is receiving $350 to get them out of the negatives and then we are giving them $750 for the year. This will help them fund their patch and other needs.

The National events Savings is receiving $992 which is $1 per every paid 2025 lodge member.

The OA High Adventure Savings will be given $760 to bring the account to a total of $3,000 which is the minimal requirement from the LEC (approved in 2019), now the account will be within LEC regulation.

We are designating $615.48 to Communications for the various subscriptions that they use to promote our lodge and show our history.

$500 is going towards the chapter expenses. This is a drop from last year due to most chapters not using the given funds. Chapters will be notified that the funds are available and how to access the funds to encourage usage.

Membership is receiving $600 for the annual New Members Bash that they host. $600 goes to cover the cost of the food and program of the New Members Bash.

We are setting $150 aside for office supplies, this can include toner and ink for the printer.

Community Service Day is receiving $150 so we can purchase the patch for the event.

Registration for the Council Annual Dinner was raised from $55 to $60 per person. We plan to send 10 youth for a total of $600. So we are putting $600 towards sending representatives to the Council Dinner.

Camp Promotions and Inductions are not receiving any funding from the lodge. If either committee wishes to be funded they can request money through the LEC.

Unit Elections is being given $375 to purchase the new Unit Elections patch since the February LEC is too close to the Unit Elections Training event for the patches to arrive in time.

The Events Committee is getting $75 for a dinner for the committee for all their hard work they do throughout the year.

$20.83 is going to Program & Miscellaneous items to zero out the budget and put as at an even budget.

Star McMackin - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 Proposed Lodge Budget. Seconded by: Aiden Sutkowsi PASSED

Unami Lodge, One History Budget (Aiden Sutkowski)

Currently the History Committee Opening balance is $14,996. Our expected income for 2025 to be about $2,545 this comes from the yard sale bringing in $1,730, our publication sales from our religion in scouting books we budgeted to bring in $40, we estimate to bring in $650 from the Memorabilia show, and we are expecting to bring in $125 from the Musser historic Trails Patch.

The expenses are estimated to be $11,916. The storage unit in Limerick is estimated to be about $1,728 for the year, but this could fluctuate due to their timeline. The Musser Historic Trails Patch costs us $500, the History Committee work day food is going to be about $150, supplies for this year will be $500, and Podcastle.ai will be $288 for the subscription. The cost to produce the African American Scouting History Book will be $2,500 and the OA handbooks for new members will cost $1,000. The Musser Historic Trails signs and posts will cost us $1,500, we are giving a $1,000 donation to Musser to help fix the wall at Camp Hart. The 95th Anniversary of Camp Hart (Incidentals) will be $250 and A History of Camp hart 1930-2025 will be $2,500. All of this totals up to $11,916.

Aidan Sutkowski - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 History Committee Proposed Budget. Seconded by: Marina Darcas PASSED

Unami Lodge, One 2025 Vigil Honor Budget (Zach Kline)

The lodge is allotting $350 to get Vigil out of the negatives from prior years, then the lodge is giving Vigil $750 for the year. We are increasing the Vigil weekend price to $35 per person and we are estimating 50 people in attendance for the Vigil weekend. We are estimating $3,000 in property sales for the Vigil committee, all of the income totals up to $5,500.

The Vigil weekend without the candidates cost $2,000. The budget is set for 10 candidates participating in the weekend. The neckerchiefs and slides were received last year in a larger purchase so they aren't needed for purchase this year. All the recognition items are budgeted for 10 people, The sashes are $18 per sash, $10 per triangle, $5 for all embroidery, $10 for each recognition frame, and to attend it is $35 per candidate. We are getting new Vigil books that will cost $300 for the order, the Vigil patch was purchased at $10 per patch at 200 patches. The Vigil Election is estimated to be $250 for the day. All of the expenses total up to $5,350 so we are budgeted for a surplus of $150 assuming the income of $5,500.

Also, please make sure you nominate fellow brothers for the Vigil recognition, they are still open.

Marina Darcas - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 Vigil Honor Proposed Budget. Seconded by: Leah Callahan PASSED

Unit Elections Training Patch (Marina Darcas)

Unit elections and past secretary made a patch to encourage youth OA members to participate in troop elections. We plan to buy 100 patches at $2.90 each to stagger the cost through the next couple years. At 100 patches this should last us around 3 years due to the average number of troops per chapter and about 10 - 15 people will receive this patch per year. The requirements to receive the patch are: Attend the February 22nd Unit Elections Training and Conduct a minimum of 5 unit elections.

There are 42 Units that havent done any elections in the past couple years. Training the chapters unit election team will get better results and if we reach a 90% completion percentage we will get 2 more PMP points and reach high performing. The Unit Elections training is on February 22nd at the Cradle of Liberty Council Office.

Marina Darcas - I would like to make a motion to approve the Unit Elections Patch Purchased at $2.90 per Unit for 100 Units. Seconded by: Doug LeBlanc PASSED

Anything for the good of the Lodge:

Matt Rouleau - Please check your email if you attended LLD this past December, you should have received an email about creating your S.M.A.R.T. goals for 2025. If you complete these goals and get them signed off by the Lodge Chief and the Lodge Advisor and send it into the Lodge Leadership Development Committee, you can earn your LLD patch. If you have already received this patch from previous years you are not able to get it again. However there is a new patch in the works so stay tuned.

Terence "T.K." Lindsay - My current job is the CVC of fellowship at the upcoming Conclave in Puerto Rico, I am looking for help with fellowship. If you would like to help with this let me know. I'm excited to work with you all.

Leah Callahan - You can buy the turtle pass now! This gives you access to 3 lodge weekends (not including Summer Inductions), for more information go to the lodge website.
This year the themes for the weekend include: Spring Service One - Netherlands, Spring Service Two - Australia, Summer Inductions - Brazil, Fall Fellowship - Japan, Lodge Dinner - Italian. The menu for the lodge dinner looks pretty good right now. Sign up for the lodge weekends now!

Amelia LeVay - If you are interested in continuing to be camp staff or would like to join the camp staff at either Resica or Musser, please sign up now.

Ian Brumm - We've been asked by council to help them out with some service at Musser Scout Reservation for a day. Please sign up for this service day. The sign up link for the Musser

service day is on the lodge website. This is a separate day from the yearly Community Service Day.

Skye Kramer - Conclave registration is still open! If you have a friend or fellow scout that has expressed interest in going to Conclave please have them sign up now. Our fundraising items are available in the lodge trading post for purchase.

Todge Sutkowski - Committee chairs and chapter officers please make sure you are putting committee reports and chapter reports into the google form under the reports section and not in the For The Good of The Lodge portion of the meeting.

Rhys Wallace - People who are looking to get rid of patches, please donate them to council because we collect them and donate them to the cub scouts. So donate your patches!

Michael Gilinger - National Jamboree sign up is live so if you intend or are interested in going you should sign up sooner than later. You also will receive some cool gear for going.

Brett Montich - Vigil nominations are open until April 30th. So go nominate brothers who you think are worthy of this recognition. Zach updated the nomination form so it should be much easier to fill out now. You can get to the form on our lodge website.

Lodge Staff Advisor Minute: John Bickel

First off go Birds! I was fired up with the new OA purpose and vision plan recently. This fired me up because I've never seen the OA be lined up with the National Scouting purpose. I'm going to share a little bit of it: As Scouting's National Honor Society, we forge lifelong bonds among the leaders in Scouting and: Recognize those who exemplify the Scout Oath and Law in their daily lives and, through that recognition, cause others to act in the same way. Reinforce a life purpose of leadership in cheerful service to others. Create and deliver peer-led, adult-guided, advanced leadership experiences for Scouts and Scouters that positively impact their unit, community, and ultimately our nation. Be an integral part of Scouting America and encourage participation in all it offers through units, outdoor adventures, and national events to further the Scouting experience. That purpose is leading us towards a vision for the Order of the Arrow: "To be why Scouts want to stay in Scouting."

We recognize scouts who positively affect their units and community. We want to be the reason why scouts want to be in scouting. Think about when you're in your committee or chapter work. Find out how you can transform scouting and make it better. Transform Scouting America through positive transformative work. We have the opportunity to ignite that spark in other scouts and we can help others transition through scouting. As we do this, we are strengthening scouting. Be the reason why Cub scouts want to stay in scouting.

Lodge Adviser Minute: Todge Sutkowski

First off, Kudos to the officers for working late nights with Sloccum. LECs have gone long but this is something important to talk about. We did a session on mental health at LLD. Many people thought this was important since we do all this stuff and we're all busy. In scouts we do the buddy system, make sure you are checking in on your buddy. The video I'm about to show you has been used in many training events, it's the Chief of Staff of the White House, the policy maker is checking in on a buddy. (*See attached Video)*

Here's a little story about mental health:
This guy's walking down a street when he falls in a hole. The walls are so steep, he can't get out. A doctor passes by, and the guy shouts up, "Hey you, can you help me out?" The doctor writes a prescription, throws it down in the hole and moves on. Then a priest comes along, and the guy shouts up "Father, I'm down in this hole, can you help me out?" The priest writes out a prayer, throws it down in the hole and moves on. Then a friend walks by. "Hey Joe, it's me, can you help me out?" And the friend jumps in the hole. Our guy says, "Are you stupid? Now we're both down here." The friend says, "Yeah, but I've been down here before, and I know the way out."

We can take a moment of our time to check in on a friend, always. The lodge can be overwhelming and it's important to check in on friends. As a Lodge Advisor checking in on a buddy, my buddy reached out to me saying he needed a reset. The lodge member suffered a loss and I checked in on him. My family member has a risky surgery coming up, and a friend reached out to me and asked me how I was doing. I want to make sure everyone is looking after each other. I've been here before and there is a way out.

Chief Minute: Martin Stacey

This LEC is always the worst of the year but with how it went so far it shows what we have coming up this year. This will be a very training oriented year and after this year things will be smoother and we will find a method of consistency. But this year is going to be a lot of development. I want to thank you all for coming out tonight. Before I wrap up, who here is new to the LEC that wasn't here last year? Thank you for joining us and I hope you all have a great year.

Closing and Song

Voting during the LEC

Quorum:
To make a motion- 60% of voting members must be present (20 of 33)
To pass a motion- 50% + 1 of present voting members must vote yay (18 for a full LEC)

Yay/Nay/Abstain/No vote
Y=Yay N=Nay A=Abstain -= No vote

Motions:
1: Approval of Last Month's Meeting Minutes: Luke Smallberger - I would like to make a motion to approve last month's meeting minutes. Seconded by: Leah Callahan PASSED
2: 2025 Lodge Budget: Star McMackin - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 Proposed Lodge Budget. Seconded by: Aiden Sutkowsi PASSED
3: History Budget Approval: Aidan Sutkowski - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 History Committee Proposed Budget. Seconded by: Marina Darcas PASSED
4: Vigil Honor Budget Approval: Marina Darcas - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 Vigil Honor Proposed Budget. Seconded by: Leah Callahan PASSED
5. Unit elections Patch: Marina Darcas - I would like to make a motion to approve the Unit Elections Patch Purchased at $2.90 per Unit for 100 Units. Seconded by: Doug LeBlanc PASSED

Committee/Chapter	**Vote**
Vice Chief 1	yyyyy
Vice Chief 2	- - - - -
Secretary	yyyyy
Treasurer	yyyyy
American Indian Affairs	yyyyy
Brotherhood	yyyyy
Camp Promotions	yyyyy
Ceremonies	- - - - -
Communications	yyyyy
Conclave	yyyyy

Events	yyyyy
History	yyyyy
Inductions	-yyyy
Lodge Leadership Development	yyyyy
Lodge Operations	yyyyy
Membership	yyy-y
NOAC	- - - - -
Ordeal	yyyyy
Service	yyyyy
Unit Elections	yyyyy
Unit Representative	yyyyy
Vigil Honor	- - - - -
Immediate Past Chief	-yyyy
Baden Powell	yyyyy
Conestoga	- - - - -
Constellation	yyyyy
Continental	yyyyy
General Nash	yyyyy
Lafayette	yyyyy
Minquas	-yyyy
Northern	yyyyy
Roosevelt	- - - - -
Triune	- y - - -
Washington	yyyyy

Lodge Chief (Only in the event of a tie)	